SUPREME COURT

APEX COURT, INTEGRATED HIERARCHY → APPOINTMENT TEXT, COLLEGIUM EVOLUTION → QUALIFICATIONS, SERVICE CONDITIONS AND → INDEPENDENCE AND ACCOUNTABILITY MUST → JURISDICTION GATEWAY AND THE → APPEALS, SPECIAL LEAVE AND

Read the thick cues out from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation q4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 APEX COURT, INTEGRATED HIERARCHY AND INSTITUTIONAL IDENTITY

APEX COURT, INTEGRATED HIERARCHY AND INSTITUTIONAL IDENTITY · ARTICLES 124-147, PART V, UNION JUDICIARY · PRIVY COUNCIL · FEDERAL COURT (1937) · CONSTITUTION (26 JAN 1950) · SC (28 JAN 1950) · SUPREME COURT

ARTICLES 124-147, PART V: UNION JUDICIARY

Privy Council → Federal Court (1937) → Constitution (26 Jan 1950) → SC (28 Jan 1950)

SUPREME COURT → HIGH COURTS → SUBORDINATE COURTS one hierarchy applies Union + State law

LIMIT: integrated does not mean unitary administration; Articles 226, 227 and 235 remain vital.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLES 124-147, PART V: UNION JUDICIARY
- Privy Council → Federal Court (1937) → Constitution (26 Jan 1950) → SC (28 Jan 1950)
- SUPREME COURT → HIGH COURTS → SUBORDINATE COURTS one hierarchy applies Union + State law; Article 141 promotes national legal uniformity.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- LIMIT: integrated does not mean unitary administration; Articles 226, 227 and 235 remain vital.
- CONTROL CARD, 28 AUG 2026 sanctioned 38 including C/I
- working strength. live roster

CHECK / LIMIT

- retirement 65 seat Delhi, Article 130
- Article 145(3): five-judge minimum for specified questions.
- MUST REMEMBER: Map Articles 124-147 with exact appointment, qualification, tenure, removal, independence, jurisdiction, precedent, review, contempt and complete-justice

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- do not merge Article 32, 136, 137, 141, 142 or 143.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Map Articles 124-147 with exact appointment, qualification, tenure, removal, independence, jurisdiction, precedent, review, contempt and complete-justice rules; do not merge Article 32, 136, 137, 141, 142 or 143.

01

STAGE 01 APPOINTMENT TEXT, COLLEGIUM EVOLUTION AND NJAC TEST

APPOINTMENT TEXT, COLLEGIUM EVOLUTION AND NJAC TEST · ARTICLE 124 · PRESIDENT APPOINTS · CONSTITUTIONALLY REQUIRED CONSULTATION · CURRENT OPERATION · COLLEGIUM RECOMMENDATION · UNION PROCESSING · PRESIDENTIAL APPOINTMENT.

ARTICLE 124: PRESIDENT APPOINTS → CONSTITUTIONALLY REQUIRED CONSULTATION

Current operation: collegium recommendation → Union processing → presidential appointment.

First Judges Case (1981) → executive primacy

Second Judges Case (1993) → judicial primacy; collegium created

Third Judges Case (1998) → SC collegium: CJI + four senior-most judges

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 124: PRESIDENT APPOINTS → CONSTITUTIONALLY REQUIRED CONSULTATION
- Current operation: collegium recommendation → Union processing → presidential appointment.
- First Judges Case (1981) → executive primacy

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Second Judges Case (1993) → judicial primacy; collegium created
- Third Judges Case (1998) → SC collegium: CJI + four senior-most judges
- 2014 99th Amendment + NJAC Act → six-member commission

CHECK / LIMIT

- Fourth Judges Case (2015): → NJAC invalid; collegium restored
- CJI SENIORITY: settled convention reflected in MoP, not express constitutional text.
- REFORM TEST: transparent criteria + diversity + time discipline without executive capture

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Second Judges Case (1993) → judicial primacy; collegium created

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REFORM TEST: transparent criteria + diversity + time discipline without executive capture.

02

STAGE 02 QUALIFICATIONS, SERVICE CONDITIONS AND REMOVAL ROUTE

QUALIFICATIONS, SERVICE CONDITIONS AND REMOVAL ROUTE · INDIAN CITIZEN + FIVE YEARS HC JUDGE OR TEN · OR DISTINGUISHED JURIST IN THE PRESIDENT'S OPINION; NO MINIMUM · SECURE TENURE TO 65 · RESIGNATION TO PRESIDENT OR ARTICLE 124(4) REMOVAL · PROVED MISBEHAVIOUR/INCAPACITY · SPECIAL MAJORITY IN EACH HOUSE · PRESIDENTIAL ORDER; CONSTITUTION SAYS REMOVAL NOT IMPEACHMENT.

ELIGIBILITY → Indian citizen + five years HC judge OR ten years HC advocate

OR distinguished jurist in the President's opinion; no minimum age.

OATH → secure tenure to 65 → resignation to President OR Article 124(4) removal

REMOVAL: proved misbehaviour/incapacity → inquiry → special majority in each House

presidential order; Constitution says removal, not impeachment.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ELIGIBILITY → Indian citizen + five years HC judge OR ten years HC advocate
- OR distinguished jurist in the President's opinion; no minimum age.
- OATH → secure tenure to 65 → resignation to President OR Article 124(4) removal

POWER / PROCEDURE

- REMOVAL: proved misbehaviour/incapacity → inquiry → special majority in each House
- presidential order; Constitution says removal, not impeachment.
- FINANCIAL FIREWALL: salary charged under Article 112(3)(d)(i)

CHECK / LIMIT

- conditions protected by Article 125
- Court administrative expenses charged under Article 146(3).
- Article 124(7): former SC judge cannot plead or act before any Indian court/authority.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- REMOVAL: proved misbehaviour/incapacity → inquiry → special majority in each House

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FINANCIAL FIREWALL salary charged under Article 112(3)(d)(i) | conditions protected by Article 125.

03

STAGE 03 INDEPENDENCE AND ACCOUNTABILITY MUST OPERATE TOGETHER

INDEPENDENCE AND ACCOUNTABILITY MUST OPERATE TOGETHER · INDEPENDENCE SHIELD APPOINTMENT INSULATION · PROTECTED CONDITIONS · ARTICLE 121 · ARTICLE 129 · ARTICLE 50 SEPARATION · BINDING AUTHORITY · ADMINISTRATIVE AND FINANCIAL AUTONOMY.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- INDEPENDENCE SHIELD appointment insulation
- protected conditions
- Article 121

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Article 129
- Article 50 separation
- binding authority

CHECK / LIMIT

- administrative and financial autonomy
- ACCOUNTABILITY CHANNELS reasoned judgments + recusals + disclosure + published collegium resolutions
- 1997 Restatement + 1999 in-house procedure: non-statutory

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Article 124(4): extreme removal endpoint; no SC judge has been removed.
- DIALECTIC independence without accountability → opacity accountability without insulation → political compliance
- VERDICT → independent decisions + transparent institutional process.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → independent decisions + transparent institutional process.

04

STAGE 04 JURISDICTION GATEWAY AND THE FEDERAL-RIGHTS ROUTES

JURISDICTION GATEWAY AND THE FEDERAL-RIGHTS ROUTES · CHOOSE THE CONSTITUTIONAL DOOR FEDERAL LEGAL DISPUTE AMONG LISTED · ARTICLE 131, EXCLUSIVE ORIGINAL · FUNDAMENTAL RIGHT ENFORCEMENT · ARTICLE 32, ITSELF A FUNDAMENTAL RIGHT OTHER PUBLIC-LAW RIGHT · HIGH COURT ARTICLE 226, WIDER IN PURPOSE · FIVE WRITS HABEAS CORPUS · PUBLIC DUTY

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
CHOOSE THE CONSTITUTIONAL DOOR federal legal dispute among listed governments → Article 131, exclusive original	FIVE WRITS habeas corpus: liberty	prohibition: stop proceeding certiorari: quash completed order	ARTICLE 131 LIMITS eligible parties + existence/extent of legal right; not a political mediation forum.
Fundamental Right enforcement → Article 32, itself a Fundamental Right other public-law right → High Court Article 226, wider in purpose	mandamus: public duty	quo warranto: test public office	Treaty proviso and Article 262 water-dispute exclusion must be checked.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CHOOSE THE CONSTITUTIONAL DOOR federal legal dispute among listed governments → Article 131, exclusive original
- Fundamental Right enforcement → Article 32, itself a Fundamental Right other public-law right → High Court Article 226, wider in purpose

POWER / PROCEDURE

- FIVE WRITS habeas corpus: liberty
- mandamus: public duty

CHECK / LIMIT

- prohibition: stop proceeding certiorari: quash completed order
- quo warranto: test public office

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ARTICLE 131 LIMITS eligible parties + existence/extent of legal right; not a political mediation forum.
- Treaty proviso and Article 262 water-dispute exclusion must be checked.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Treaty proviso and Article 262 water-dispute exclusion must be checked.

05

STAGE 05 APPEALS, SPECIAL LEAVE AND PRESIDENTIAL REFERENCE

APPEALS, SPECIAL LEAVE AND PRESIDENTIAL REFERENCE · APPELLATE ROUTES · ARTICLE 132 · CERTIFICATE PROCESS · ARTICLE 136 · EXTRAORDINARY DISCRETIONARY SPECIAL LEAVE, NOT A REGULAR FOURTH APPEAL · ARTICLE 143 ADVISORY ROUTE · PUBLIC-IMPORTANCE QUESTION; COURT MAY REPORT OPINION.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
APPELLATE ROUTES	Article 136 extraordinary discretionary special leave, not a regular fourth appeal on SLP from Armed Forces courts or tribunals.	2025 ASSENT OPINION: no rigid court-made timelines or automatic deemed assent	Structure, PIL and judicial legislation proposition-specific.
Article 132: constitutional	ARTICLE 143 ADVISORY ROUTE	prolonged unexplained inaction remains reviewable. Use as dated, issue-specific evidence.	Article 142 supplies complete justice in a cause or matter, not free-standing power to ignore substantive law.
133: civil	143(1): public-importance question; Court may report opinion	State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor of Tamil Nadu (2025) → facts-specific assent relief.	
134: criminal	143(2): dispute within Article 131 proviso; Court shall hear and report	In re Assent, Withholding or Reservation of Bills (2025) → advisory control.	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- APPELLATE ROUTES
- Article 132: constitutional
- 133: civil
- 134: criminal
- 134A: certificate process

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Article 136 extraordinary discretionary special leave, not a regular fourth appeal no SLP from Armed Forces courts or tribunals.
- ARTICLE 143 ADVISORY ROUTE
- 143(1): public-importance question; Court may report opinion
- 143(2): dispute within Article 131 proviso; Court shall hear and report
- Opinion remains advisory, not an ordinary binding decree.

CHECK / LIMIT

- 2025 ASSENT OPINION: no rigid court-made timelines or automatic deemed assent
- prolonged unexplained inaction remains reviewable. Use as dated, issue-specific evidence.
- State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor of Tamil Nadu (2025) → facts-specific assent relief.
- In re Assent, Withholding or Reservation of Bills (2025) → advisory control.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Keep collegium doctrine, NJAC invalidation, judicial review, Basic

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Structure, PIL and judicial legislation proposition-specific.
- Article 142 supplies complete justice in a cause or matter, not free-standing power to ignore substantive law.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Structure, PIL and judicial legislation proposition-specific. Article 142 supplies complete justice in a cause or matter, not free-standing power to ignore substantive law.

06

STAGE 06 FINALITY, REVIEW, CURATIVE POWER AND CONTEMPT

FINALITY, REVIEW, CURATIVE POWER AND CONTEMPT · ARTICLE 137 REVIEW · FINALITY REVIEW CORRECTS PRESCRIBED ERROR; IT IS NOT A · AFTER REVIEW DISMISSAL · CURATIVE PETITION · RUPA ASHOK HURRA (2002) · RARE GRAVE-MISCARRIAGE ROUTE WITH ADDED SAFEGUARDS · NO ROUTINE SECOND REVIEW.

JUDGMENT → ARTICLE 137 REVIEW → FINALITY review corrects prescribed error; it is not a

AFTER REVIEW DISMISSAL → CURATIVE PETITION

Rupa Ashok Hurra (2002): rare grave-miscarriage route with added safeguards

LIMIT: no routine second review.

ARTICLE 129: COURT OF RECORD permanent authoritative records + constitutional contempt power civil contempt →

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- JUDGMENT → ARTICLE 137 REVIEW → FINALITY review corrects prescribed error; it is not a rehearing of the appeal.
- AFTER REVIEW DISMISSAL → CURATIVE PETITION

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Rupa Ashok Hurra (2002): rare grave-miscarriage route with added safeguards
- LIMIT: no routine second review.

CHECK / LIMIT

- ARTICLE 129: COURT OF RECORD permanent authoritative records + constitutional contempt power civil contempt → wilful disobedience
- criminal contempt → substantial interference fair criticism and statutory truth defence protect speech; power protects justice, not ego.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- JUDGMENT → ARTICLE 137 REVIEW → FINALITY review corrects prescribed error; it is not a rehearing of the appeal.
- AFTER REVIEW DISMISSAL → CURATIVE PETITION

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ARTICLE 129: COURT OF RECORD permanent authoritative records + constitutional contempt power civil contempt → wilful disobedience | criminal contempt → substantial interference fair criticism and statutory truth defence protect speech; power protects justice, not ego.

07

STAGE 07 PRECEDENT, COMPLETE JUSTICE, ASSISTANCE AND PROCEDURE

PRECEDENT, COMPLETE JUSTICE, ASSISTANCE AND PROCEDURE · ARTICLE 141 · RATIO OF LAW DECLARED BINDS ALL COURTS LARGER BENCH · ARTICLE 142 · COMPLETE JUSTICE IN THE CAUSE OR MATTER BEFORE THE · PREM CHAND GARG · CANNOT VIOLATE FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS · SUPREME COURT BAR ASSOCIATION (1998)

ARTICLE 141 → ratio of law declared binds all courts larger Bench smaller Bench; coordinate

ARTICLE 142 → complete justice in the cause or matter before the Court

Prem Chand Garg → cannot violate Fundamental Rights

Supreme Court Bar Association (1998) → cannot supplant substantive law.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 141 → ratio of law declared binds all courts larger Bench smaller Bench; coordinate disagreement ordinarily goes to larger Bench.
- ARTICLE 142 → complete justice in the cause or matter before the Court
- Prem Chand Garg → cannot violate Fundamental Rights

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Supreme Court Bar Association (1998) → cannot supplant substantive law.
- ARTICLE 144 → civil and judicial authorities act in aid.
- ARTICLE 145 → rules; five-judge floor for Article 143 and substantial interpretation.

CHECK / LIMIT

- CONTINUITY TOOLS
- 126 acting CJI
- 127 ad hoc judge

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- 128 retired judge sitting: distinct consent routes.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 126 acting CJI | 127 ad hoc judge | 128 retired judge sitting: distinct consent routes.

08

STAGE 08 JUDICIAL REVIEW, BASIC STRUCTURE, NINTH SCHEDULE AND TRIBUNALS

JUDICIAL REVIEW, BASIC STRUCTURE, NINTH SCHEDULE AND TRIBUNALS · CONSTITUTIONAL SUPREMACY · REVIEW OF LAW + EXECUTIVE ACTION + AMENDMENT EFFECT · KESAVANANDA BHARATI (1973) · AMENDMENT CANNOT DAMAGE BASIC STRUCTURE · MINERVA MILLS (1980) · LIMITED POWER + PARTS III-IV HARMONY · I.R. COELHO (2007)

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CONSTITUTIONAL SUPREMACY → REVIEW OF LAW + EXECUTIVE ACTION + AMENDMENT EFFECT
- Kesavananda Bharati (1973) → amendment cannot damage Basic Structure
- Minerva Mills (1980) → limited power + Parts III-IV harmony

POWER / PROCEDURE

- I.R. Coelho (2007) — post-24 Apr 1973 Ninth Schedule insertions face impact review
- LIMIT: reviewability is not automatic invalidity.
- TRIBUNAL FLOOR

CHECK / LIMIT

- L. Chandra Kumar (1997) → tribunals may supplement adjudication
- BUT Articles 226/227 High Court review and Article 32 review cannot be wholly excluded.
- Specialisation remains under constitutional-court supervision.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- I.R. Coelho (2007) — post-24 Apr 1973 Ninth Schedule insertions face impact review

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BUT Articles 226/227 High Court review and Article 32 review cannot be wholly excluded.

09

STAGE 09 PIL, ACTIVISM, JUDICIAL LEGISLATION AND ENVIRONMENT

PIL, ACTIVISM, JUDICIAL LEGISLATION AND ENVIRONMENT · ACCESS EXPANSION RELAXED LOCUS STANDI + EPISTOLARY JURISDICTION + · HUSSAINARA KHATOON (1979) · SPEEDY TRIAL · S.P. GUPTA (1981) · REPRESENTATIVE STANDING · STANDING IS RELAXED, NOT ERASED; SCREEN BONA FIDES AND · JUDICIAL LEGISLATION

ACCESS EXPANSION relaxed locus standi + epistolary jurisdiction + continuing mandamus

Hussainara Khatoon (1979): speedy trial

S.P. Gupta (1981): representative standing

LIMIT: standing is relaxed, not erased; screen bona fides and administrability.

JUDICIAL LEGISLATION

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ACCESS EXPANSION relaxed locus standi + epistolary jurisdiction + continuing mandamus
- Hussainara Khatoon (1979): speedy trial
- S.P. Gupta (1981): representative standing

POWER / PROCEDURE

- LIMIT: standing is relaxed, not erased; screen bona fides and administrability.
- JUDICIAL LEGISLATION
- Vishaka (1997): rights-based interim norm in legal vacuum until 2013 legislation legitimacy

CHECK / LIMIT

- test → right + vacuum + necessity + temporary, legally anchored remedy.
- ENVIRONMENTAL LINE
- Article 21 + 48A + 51A(g) → absolute liability, precaution, polluter pays, public trust

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Court catalyses compliance; CPCB, State boards and NGT remain indispensable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Court catalyses compliance; CPCB, State boards and NGT remain indispensable.

10

STAGE 10 COMPARISON, DIVERSITY, PROFESSION AND DELIVERY REFORM

COMPARISON, DIVERSITY, PROFESSION AND DELIVERY REFORM · EQUALITY + LEGITIMACY + WIDER PROFESSIONAL PIPELINE · FATHIMA BEEVI (1989) · FIRST WOMAN SC JUDGE; AVOID UNDATED PERCENTAGES. · SHARED PRECEDENT; CONSTITUTIONAL SUPREMACY VERSUS PARLIAMENTARY SOVEREIGNTY · COLLEGIUM + RETIREMENT 65 VERSUS NOMINATION + SENATE + · STATE BAR COUNCILS ENROL, BCI SETS NATIONAL STATUTORY STANDARDS · BCI IS STATUTORY, NOT CONSTITUTIONAL; COURTS RETAIN PRACTICE AND

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
DIVERSITY → equality + legitimacy + wider professional pipeline	INDIA-UK → shared precedent; constitutional supremacy versus parliamentary sovereignty	PROFESSION → State Bar Councils enrol; BCI sets national statutory standards and appeals	DELIVERY CHAIN accessible filing → timely listing/hearing → reasoned order → implementation technology + legal aid + judges + case management
Fathima Beevi (1989): first woman SC judge; avoid undated percentages.	INDIA-USA → collegium + retirement 65 versus nomination + Senate + good-behaviour tenure	BCI is statutory, not constitutional; courts retain practice and proceeding rules.	e-Courts alone cannot cure exclusion.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- DIVERSITY → equality + legitimacy + wider professional pipeline
- Fathima Beevi (1989): first woman SC judge; avoid undated percentages.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- INDIA-UK → shared precedent; constitutional supremacy versus parliamentary sovereignty
- INDIA-USA → collegium + retirement 65 versus nomination + Senate + good-behaviour tenure

CHECK / LIMIT

- PROFESSION → State Bar Councils enrol; BCI sets national statutory standards and appeals
- BCI is statutory, not constitutional; courts retain practice and proceeding rules.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- DELIVERY CHAIN accessible filing → timely listing/hearing → reasoned order → implementation technology + legal aid + judges + case management
- e-Courts alone cannot cure exclusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DELIVERY CHAIN accessible filing → timely listing/hearing → reasoned order → implementation technology + legal aid + judges + case management; e-Courts alone cannot cure exclusion.

11

STAGE 11 PRELIMS FIREWALLS, PYQ ROUTES AND EXAMINER-READY SYNTHESIS

PRELIMS FIREWALLS, PYQ ROUTES AND EXAMINER-READY SYNTHESIS · PRELIMS FIREWALL · ARTICLE 32 NARROWER IN PURPOSE THAN 226 · ARTICLE 136 DISCRETIONARY · 143 ADVISORY · ARTICLE 142 BOUNDED · CONSTITUTION BENCH MINIMUM FIVE · CURATIVE IS EXCEPTIONAL COLLEGIUM NOT CONSTITUTIONAL TEXT

PRELIMS FIREWALL

Article 32 narrower in purpose than 226

Article 136 discretionary

143 advisory

Article 142 bounded

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PRELIMS FIREWALL
- Article 32 narrower in purpose than 226
- Article 136 discretionary
- 143 advisory
- Article 142 bounded

POWER / PROCEDURE

- curative is exceptional collegium not constitutional text
- removal is not impeachment
- working strength is dated.
- PYQ ROUTES
- judicial legislation/PIL

CHECK / LIMIT

- PIL and judicial power
- constitutional morality
- India-USA appointments
- MAKING SPINE define institutional role → Article → mechanism → case + year → consequence
- counterpoint/limit → matched reform → qualified conclusion.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- to reasoned restraint, accountable process, accessible remedies and executable orders.
- LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: Act 14 of 2026 raises the statutory maximum to thirty-seven judges excluding
- the CJI, total sanctioned strength thirty-eight, deemed in force from 16 May 2026.
- Working strength and pendency remain dynamic.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: Act 14 of 2026 raises the statutory maximum to thirty-seven judges excluding the CJI, total sanctioned strength thirty-eight, deemed in force from 16 May 2026.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · A1. CONSTITUTION BENCHES, PRECEDENT AND INSTITUTIONAL VOICE · A2. ARTICLE 141 AND ARTICLE 142 ARE DIFFERENT POWERS. · A3. THE COURT'S POWER AND ITS COMPLIANCE DEPENDENCY · A4. CONTINUING MANDAMUS · REMEDY OR ADMINISTRATION? · A5. APPOINTMENT REFORM MATRIX · A6. CONCISE SOURCE AND CURRENT-CONTROL NOTE

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- A1. Constitution Benches, precedent and institutional voice
- A2. Article 141 and Article 142 are different powers
- A3. The Court's power and its compliance dependency
- A4. Continuing mandamus: remedy or administration?

ADVANCED LIMIT

- A5. Appointment reform matrix
- A6. Concise source and current-control note
- [FACT] Article 145(3) creates a five-judge minimum, not a five-judge maximum.
- [FACT] Ratio and bench strength determine binding authority under Article 141.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- [ANALYSIS] Frequent small-bench adjudication improves throughput but can create fragmentation when nationally important issues are not referred promptly.
- [LIMIT] A later small bench cannot silently neutralise a larger bench; genuine conflict requires reference.
- [ANALYSIS] Confusing the two converts a case-specific remedy into a general
- law or, conversely, understates the precedential principle that actually binds.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.